which is part of the western air command of the Indian Air Force. The ISI-backed and Pakistan-based United Jihad Council was quick to claim responsibility. The attackers, who were wearing Indian Army combat fatigues, were subsequently suspected to belong to Jaish-e-Mohammed which is led by Masood Azhar. Telephone calls made by the attackers were tracked down to two Pakistani numbers, one of which belonged to the terrorists' handler, a Jaish-e-Mohammed operative. This attack was meant to test the resolve of the Government of India and assess how it reacts.

The next attempt came in July 2016 and started with the killing of Burhan Wani, a commander of the POK-based Islamic militant organisation, Hizb-ul-Mujahideen, by Indian security forces.[38] After his killing, anti-Indian protests started in all 10 districts of the Kashmir Valley. Protestors defied curfews with attacks on security forces and public properties. The valley remained under 53 days of consecutive curfew, with the government having to rush in additional forces to contain the agitation.[39] The unrest, which went on for months till February 2017, resulted in the deaths of more than 90 civilians and left over 15,000 injured. This 2016–17 unrest in Kashmir is also known as the 'Burhan aftermath'.[40]

While the state was still reeling from this unrest, Pakistan struck once again. On 18 September 2016, four heavily armed militants, later identified to be members of Jaish-e-Mohammed attacked brigade headquarters of the Indian Army outside Uri. It was reported as 'the deadliest attack on security forces in Kashmir in two decades'.[41] This time India struck back. On 29 September 2016, 11 days after the dreadful Uri attack, the Indian Army announced that it had successfully conducted surgical strikes against suspected militants in POK.

Two months later, shelling intensified in and around the Kishenganga Dam and the intensity and regularity of shelling continued till the end of the year.[42]

Many of the temporary workers at the dam left only to return when the Burhan aftermath ended in 2017. The Pakistani Army intensified shelling in the Gurez sector causing the workers to periodically take shelter in tunnels